SPRING 2027 | SEMINAR IN HISPANIC LINGUISTICS | TAUGHT IN SPANISH

What makes Spanish *ordinary* – and *extraordinary* – among the world's languages?

THE MANY SPANISHES: What Spanish Variation Reveals About Language Itself



WHAT WE'LL EXPLORE

01 Spanish's Global Surprises
Most of the world's languages have no subjunctive mood, don't drop subject pronouns, and don't split "to be" into *ser* and *estar*. Discover where Spanish stands on the global map.

02 One Language, Many Systems
Why do Caribbean speakers say *"¿Qué tú quieres?"* while Andean speakers drop pronouns almost entirely? Trace how grammar adapts across communities.

03 Worlds in Contact
What happens when Spanish lives alongside Quechua, Guaraní, English in the U.S., or African languages in Equatorial Guinea? Explore how contact reshapes a language.

INSIDE THE SEMINAR

Interactive Maps & Visual Tools
Explore real patterns across the Spanish-speaking world using interactive atlases, visual apps, and critical checks on how AI handles variation.

Think Like a Linguist
Move beyond textbook rules to uncover why every variety of Spanish has its own internal logic, structure, and history.

Hands-On Discovery
Learn by doing: investigate real-world case studies, test competing ideas with evidence, and build your own capstone showcase.

COUNTS FOR SPANISH MAJOR & MINOR LANGUAGE / LINGUISTICS SEMINAR

SPA 379 TR 9:30–10:45am · **Prof. Jerid Francom**
Department of Spanish · Wake Forest University
P SPA 320
Note: if you have taken SPA 309, request Workday pre-req override for SPA 320

EXPLORE THE COURSE
Scan for syllabus, topics & preview